TUESDAY 19 JANUARY 2027 · SAN FRANCISCO

# Something in the air.

EARF makes hi-fi and light in cast acrylic, tinted all the way through, in eight colours. On 19 January the first pair of Tropos, our horn loudspeaker, plays for the first time, in San Francisco, at a debut night in FOG week. After it, we plan to keep a listening room open for eight weeks, and a partner's support is one of the things that makes that happen. We are looking for three partners to make the night theirs as much as ours: a hotel, a drinks brand, and a record label or shop.



THE NIGHT

## Tue 19 Jan 2027

The pop-up's opening; [time], [venue]

THE WEEK

## SF Art Week

16–24 Jan; FOG Design+Art at Fort Mason, 21–24 Jan

AFTER IT

## A room, planned

A listening room we plan to keep open for eight weeks, Thursday to Sunday, if partners and grants allow

THE GUESTS

## 48 organisations

Design galleries, studios, hi-fi, records, hospitality; and the press

PICTURES ARE RENDERS: ON THE NIGHT, THE REAL THING

# One night, the first pictures that aren't renders, and a room to follow.

## Who will be in the room

Collectors and dealers in town for FOG Design+Art: galleries from its 2027 list (Marta, Patrick Parrish, Hostler Burrows, Gallery FUMI and others). San Francisco's design studios and showrooms. The city's hi-fi shops and listening bars. Record labels and shops. Hotel and hospitality groups. And the design, city and hi-fi press, briefed for a spring launch.

## What every partner gets

- Named on the printed invitation and the email (both drafted)
- A Session of its own: one album, start to finish, in the listening room, under its name
- Its product in the room on the night, and in the listening room after it if the room goes ahead
- Named in the spring press release and the fact sheet
- Use of the night's photographs and the teaser film
- A first conversation about an edition in one of the eight colours (est.; nothing promised)

A HOTEL

### Near Fort Mason, Union Square or Jackson Square

- Rooms for visiting guests and press in FOG week
- A room for the after-hours Session, or the night's sound and light
- Later: a listening suite, fitted by EARF

`Ask: $5k–15k cash, or rooms and space in kind (est. value $3k–10k)`

A DRINKS BRAND

### Spirits, or non-alcoholic

- The night's drinks, named, through a licensed caterer
- A drink for each tint, Ember to Smoke
- Its bottles on the bar on Fridays, if the room goes ahead

`Ask: product and bartending in kind (est. value $2k–8k), or cash, structured with counsel`

A RECORD LABEL OR SHOP

### Bay Area first

- The room's records, chosen with them
- A selector or artist set on the night
- The first Session, possibly recorded and pressed (EARF Sessions)

`Ask: records, an artist set and a Session in kind; or $5k toward the pressing`

## The timeline

| WHEN | WHAT |
|---|---|
| By mid-December | Partners agreed; names and logos for the invitation |
| Week of 4 January | Invitations out, to the 48 organisations and the press; the partner named on each |
| Tuesday 19 January | The opening: the first pair plays; the partner's drinks, records and Session; photographs |
| 16–24 January | SF Art Week; FOG Design+Art at Fort Mason, 21–24 January; the night's guests and the fair's visitors in town |
| After the night (planned) | A listening room for eight weeks, Thursday to Sunday, if the Vacant to Vibrant grant, partners and deposits fund it; the partner's product in it if it opens |
| 22–29 March | The spring press release, with the partners named |

**Drinks and the law.** California's tied-house rules bar alcohol makers and wholesalers from furnishing money or things of value to on-sale licensees, with narrow exceptions (B&P §25500). Any spirits partnership is structured with counsel, and drinks on the night are served through a licensed caterer (the pop-up's plan uses Type 58 caterer nights). A non-alcoholic partner avoids the question.

# Who we'd ask first, and why.

| PARTNER | WHY IT FITS | PUBLIC CONTACT ROUTE (SEEN 31 OCT 2026) |
|---|---|---|
| HOTELS | | |
| **The Battery**<br>Jackson Square | A members' club and hotel whose members are the city's creative and tech crowd: Planet EARF's buyers, two streets from the galleries | press@thebatterysf.com |
| **Palihotel San Francisco**<br>Union Square | A design-driven group: lamps in its lobby, a listening corner, rooms for FOG guests | events@palihotelsf.com; info@palisociety.com |
| **Hotel Emblem**<br>Union Square | A Beat-generation hotel with an arts programme: a natural home for a Session | sales@hotelemblem.com |
| **San Francisco Proper**<br>Mid-Market | Design-led (Kelly Wearstler); its group's press notes a feature on hotels for music lovers | Press through its agency, proper@autumncommunications.com |
| DRINKS | | |
| **St. George Spirits**<br>Alameda | The Bay's own distillery, with private and public events of its own. Its page says it is not taking donation requests: pitch as marketing, not a gift | Contact form (Marketing, Private event); stgeorgespirits.com/contact |
| **Ghia**<br>non-alcoholic aperitif | Design-led, colour-saturated, non-alcoholic: no tied-house question, and a drink for each tint | partnerships@drinkghia.com |
| **The New Bar**<br>alcohol-free shop | An alcohol-free shop that runs events and partnerships; a whole zero-proof list for the room | Contact form (Events & partnerships); press@thenewbar.com |
| **Seedlip**<br>non-alcoholic spirits | The category's best-known name; a clean, no-alcohol night | Contact form (Trade inquiry) on seedlipdrinks.com |
| RECORDS | | |
| **Stranded Records + Superior Viaduct**<br>Mission and Oakland | A curated shop and its reissue label: the room's crates and a Session on a new release | info@strandedrecords.com; press@superiorviaduct.com |
| **Dark Entries Records**<br>San Francisco | The city's defining archival label, with a DJ following: a selector set for the night | Contact form on its Bandcamp page |
| **Light in the Attic**<br>Seattle and LA | A reissue label whose catalogue suits a listening session, start to finish | press@lightintheattic.net |
| **Craft Recordings**<br>(Fantasy's catalogue) | Bay Area jazz history and audiophile reissues: a Session that sounds like the speakers | info@craftrecordings.com |

Nothing has been sent; no one has been contacted. Routes were seen on each organisation's own site on 31 October 2026; re-check before writing. The pitch for each type is drafted in money/PARTNERS.md.